

Weekly Newsletter 2025-W54

How to use storytelling to teach any subject



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Introduction

Storytelling is one of the oldest and most powerful teaching tools. Long before textbooks and smart boards existed, knowledge was passed through stories. Even today, stories capture attention, spark curiosity, and make learning memorable.

When teachers use storytelling, lessons become meaningful, emotional, and engaging. Whether you teach English, Maths, Science, Social Studies, or even vocational subjects, storytelling can transform how students understand and remember concepts.

This newsletter explores **simple, practical ways to use storytelling across subjects**, even in classrooms with limited resources.

Why Storytelling Works in the Classroom

Storytelling:

- Captures student attention naturally
- Improves memory and understanding
- Builds emotional connection with content
- Encourages imagination and creativity
- Supports diverse learning styles
- Makes complex concepts easier

Students remember stories far better than isolated facts.

How to Use Storytelling in Any Subject

1. Start with a Character

Introduce a character related to the lesson.

- A curious child
- A scientist
- A traveller
- A shopkeeper
- A historical figure

Example:

In Maths, a shopkeeper uses fractions while selling goods.

In Science, a raindrop explains the water cycle.

2. Turn Concepts into Situations

Present lessons as real-life situations.

- A problem to solve
- A journey
- A challenge

- A discovery

This helps students relate learning to everyday life.

3. Use Storytelling in Different Subjects

- **English:** Moral stories, role play, dialogue building
- **Maths:** Story problems, real-life calculations
- **Science:** Experiments as adventures, discoveries
- **Social Studies:** Historical events as narratives
- **EVS:** Nature stories, community experiences

Storytelling makes abstract ideas concrete.

Did You Know?

Studies show that learners retain up to **22 times more information** when lessons are delivered through stories instead of plain facts. Storytelling activates both logical and emotional parts of the brain.

Simple Storytelling Techniques for Teachers

1. Use Voice and Expressions

Change tone, speed, and expressions to keep students hooked. Even simple lessons become engaging with expressive narration.

2. Encourage Student Storytelling

Ask students to:

- Continue a story
- Create endings
- Act out scenes
- Narrate lessons in their own words

This boosts confidence, speaking skills, and creativity.

3. Visual Story Aids

Use:

- Blackboard drawings
- Charts
- Flashcards
- Gestures

No technology required just imagination

4. Story + Question Strategy

Pause your story and ask:

- “What do you think happens next?”
- “Why did the character do this?”

This keeps attention high and promotes critical thinking.

Here are some reference links to empower your knowledge and deepen your understanding

[Mastering Storytelling in the Classroom: Engaging and Inspiring Students](#)

[The Power of Storytelling as a Teaching Method – Vortex Quest](#)

Watch this quick video to grasp the concept -

[Storytelling Strategy in classroom | Effective Teaching Strategy | Powerful teaching tool](#)

Latest Education Update

IIT Kharagpur launches India’s first Master’s in Indian Knowledge System

IIT Kharagpur has unveiled a pioneering **Master’s programme in Indian Knowledge System (IKS)**, set to begin in June 2026. The interdisciplinary programme will blend classical Indian sciences, philosophy, and language studies with modern academic and AI-driven tools marking a unique academic initiative in Indian higher education. [The Times of India](#)

Inspirational Teachers' Story



**Pankaj Kumar
Goyal**

In Barnala, Punjab, Pankaj Kumar Goyal began his career as a clerk in the Education Department, but his heart was never content with paperwork. Driven by a passion for teaching, he pursued his dream and stepped into the classroom of Government Senior Secondary School for

Girls. With vision and dedication, he transformed lessons into life-changing experiences, inspiring his students to believe in themselves.

His efforts bore fruit when 31 girls from his school secured places on the state's merit list in 2022 and 2023, proving that education could break barriers and open doors to opportunity.

His journey from clerk to celebrated educator reached a pinnacle on Teachers' Day 2024, when President Droupadi Murmu honored him with the National Teachers' Award. Yet, his true achievement lies beyond recognition it is in the ripple effect of his work. Each girl he taught carried forward the light of education into her family and community, creating a cycle of empowerment. Pankaj Kumar Goyal's story is a testament to how one teacher's vision and perseverance can transform not just classrooms, but society itself.

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